

Road printer

A road printer, designed by a team of three from Designory, works on solar energy and prints important traffic signs on the road

Paper standards

Printer papers are categorized as non-recycled, 30 per cent recycled and 100 per cent recycled paper

MFD test

on's MF4680, Ricoh's SP110SF and Xerox 'sWorkCentre 3220 have USB drive support, which allows you to save your scanned copies directly to the pen drive. Operating the software accompanying each MFD was quite simple.

Performance

In this category we concentrated more on the speed and economy of prints. Users in this category want a quality print at a lower per-page cost. We performed the text print, mixed document print, copying, scanning and scanning via ADF.

Printing text documents took under 10 seconds for most of the MFDs except for the Aficio SP C232SF, which took a crazy 25 seconds for a single text print. But it was comparatively faster during the continuous mixed document printing. Canon's imageCLASS MF4380dn was the fastest during text printing at 7.3 secs and also the best quality among all the other MFDs.

Xerox WorkCentre 3220 took a mere 14 seconds to print five documents that had images and text in the fast mode. Its quality was superior to the others in the test. Aficio SP110SF was the

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slowest in the mixed document printing test taking 60 seconds to print the five documents.

Copying functionality was the best in the Canon and Xerox MFDs. All of them took under 10 seconds to print a single page and around 18 seconds to print five pages in the fast mode. It was noticed that the quality of MFDs was the best in the ones that gave the quickest results.

At 18 seconds, scanning to the PC was the fastest in Canon imageCLASS MF4350d



Ricoh Aficio SP 1100SF

whereas Aficio SP 1100SF was the slowest at 68 seconds. While scanning from the ADF was the fastest in Aficio SP C232SF at just 20 seconds for scanning five pages of text and images.

The Ricoh Aficio SP C232SF gave great colour results which were comparable to the best performer in the inkjet category, but was sluggish in most of the monochrome tests when compared to its competitors.

Conclusion

The Epson Office Stylus TX600FW was the clear winner in the tests of the inkjet colour MFDs as it had the best features and gave a decent performance. It was judged as the Best Performer. However, the Best Buy was awarded to Brother DCP 195C for its very economical Rs. 4,540 price tag. Having said that, DCP 195C also gave a performance that was third best among the

seven inkjets that we tested. The second product that we felt deserved a mention for an affordable price was the Canon

Pixma MP276.

Among the monochrome laser MFDs, the Xerox WorkCentre 3220 was judged as the Best Performer for its quality prints at comparatively faster speeds. It was a consistent performer in all the benchmark performance tests. Pricing of the WorkCentre may work to its disadvantage at Rs. 30,719. Canon's imageCLASS MF4350 is very decently priced at Rs. 18,995 and it gave a performance of around 86 per cent of the WorkCentre 3220.

Brother DCP 7030 was judged as the Best Value product due to its very economical pricing of Rs. 9,090. This was the lowest price among all the contenders. Despite the low price, it gave an almost 70 per cent performance as compared to the Best Performer. **d**



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